

Illustrative render of the finished design - not a photograph of a sample

Axel the Axolotl

One-piece spiral body · six fluffy gills · shell-edged paddle tail · seated 11.5 cm

CROCHET PATTERN · US TERMS · ADVANCED BEGINNER · INK-FRIENDLY PRINT LAYOUT

✓ 5-AXIOM MATH VERIFIED ON PAPER | **36 ROUNDS** | **5 PIECES** | **6 MM EYES** | **WORSTED #4**

● PALE PINK - MAIN ○ DARK PINK - GILLS & FIN named original colourway

WHAT YOU GET	VERIFICATION	PRINT NOTES
36-round one-piece spiral body Arms, feet, gills and fin tables Component tick-box checklist	✓ 5-axiom mathematical audit 63 / 63 count checks pass Paper-verified: no sample crocheted	9 pages on US Letter No full-bleed colour pages Tables sized for home printers

One spiral, five sewn-on pieces

head, neck, body and tail in one continuous spiral - no neck seam to sew;
arms, feet, six gills and the shell-edged fin are sewn on at stated rounds.

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Personal & small-batch finished-item licence · Design Code NS-03 · pattern text machine-verified (crochet-check v1.0.0)
Cover artwork is an illustrative render of the written design - not a photograph of a sample.

Welcome, Contents & How to Use This Pattern

A soft pink axolotl with six fluffy gills, a round head and a shell-edged paddle tail. Head, neck, body and tail are one continuous spiral - no neck seam to sew. Seated Axel stands about 11.5 cm (4.5 in) tall and measures about 10 cm (4 in) from gill tip to gill tip.

Tick each **[ ]** box only after the row's stated count matches your work. Work in a continuous spiral: do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds - move a stitch marker up into the first stitch of every round. Diagrams support orientation; the numbered written directions control.

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Format	**US terms, continuous spiral**	**Skill**	**Advanced beginner**
Time	2.5 - 3 hours plus finishing	Hook	3.5 mm (US E/4)
Finished size	11.5 cm seated · 10 cm gill span · 4.3 cm tail	Eyes	two 6 mm safety eyes
Pieces	1 body, 2 arms, 2 feet, 6 gills, 1 fin	Yarn	Worsted #4 pink + fuzzy dark pink

Safety & Materials

Toy safety, not a toy claim - read this first
Axel uses two 6 mm plastic safety eyes. If an eye, washer or surrounding stitch fails, it can release a small part: lock the washers firmly from the inside before stuffing, then check each eye and the surrounding fabric by hand. If a post, washer or stitch shifts, do not supply or use the item. The gills, arms, feet and tail fin are all sewn or worked on: sew each seam twice and weave every end in for at least 5 cm, then trim close.

No compliance claim is made
No finished Axel has been shown by Novality Store to comply with ASTM F963, EN 71 or another toy-safety regime; do not describe one as baby-safe or compliant. Embroidered eyes remove the plastic-eye detachment hazard but do not by themselves establish suitability for any age. Before supply, the finished-item maker or seller must determine all applicable classification, assessment, testing, documentation, labelling and traceability duties.

- Main yarn: worsted #4, pale pink, about 15 g. Cotton or acrylic with a smooth matte finish - one 25 g ball covers the whole axolotl.
- Gill yarn: fuzzy / eyelash / fur yarn, dark pink, about 8 g. Essential: smooth worsted will not give fluffy gills, and the gills are the whole look.
- Fin yarn: worsted #4, dark pink, about 3 g, smooth - so the shell edging stays crisp.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E/4) for a tight gauge so stuffing cannot show through.
- Eyes: two 6 mm safety eyes (9 mm reads as buggy on this head).
- Also: polyester filling about 8 g; tapestry needle; black and pink embroidery floss; stitch marker.

Gauge, Size & Abbreviations

Gauge: 36 sc around measures about 52 mm across when stuffed (4.5 mm per stitch, 4.3 mm per round). Wider than 55 mm across? Drop to a 3.0 mm hook. Under 48 mm across? Go up to a 4.0 mm hook.

Abbr.	Meaning	Abbr.	Meaning
MR	magic ring	sc	single crochet
ch	chain	dc	double crochet
inc	increase (2 sc in one st)	invdec	invisible decrease
sl st	slip stitch	st(s)	stitch(es)
FO	fasten off	(n)	stitch count at round end

Worked in a continuous spiral: do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds - just keep going round after round, moving the marker up into the first stitch each time.

Techniques, In The Order You Meet Them

1. The magic ring The body, arms, feet and gills begin with a magic ring. Wrap the yarn once around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop and work the first round into the ring, then pull the tail tight. The surface-worked tail fin does not use a magic ring.	**2. Working in a spiral** Do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds - just keep going round after round. Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up each time; there is no join to count from.
3. The invisible decrease Insert the hook through the front loops only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through both, then yarn over and pull through the remaining two loops. It leaves no ridge, which matters on the head and neck where decreases are visible.	**4. Closing through both layers** To close a flat opening, fold the piece flat so the front and back layers lie together, then work one sc through each matched pair of stitches. Axel's 6-stitch tail tip folds into 3 pairs and closes with 3 sc.
5. The shell (scallop) Work all the stitches of the group into one stitch, then slip stitch into the next stitch to anchor it. The group fans into a cup. Working the dc loosely makes each scallop cup outward instead of lying flat.	

Instructions 1 - Head, Body & Tail (One Piece, Main Pink)

Worked in a single spiral from the top of the head straight through to the tail tip. Head and body are both 36 stitches around; the neck at Rnd 13 is the only waist. Three straight rounds at the head keep it spherical rather than egg-shaped.

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R1	6 sc in MR	**(6)**	start at top of head
	R2	inc in each st around	**(12)**	-
	R3	[sc, inc] x 6	**(18)**	-
	R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	**(24)**	-
	R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	**(30)**	-
	R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	**(36)**	head at full width
	R7	sc in each st around	**(36)**	eye row: between R7 and R8 (install after R9)
	R8	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R9	sc in each st around	**(36)**	lock eye washers and embroider face now
	R10	[4 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(30)**	-

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R11	[3 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(24)**	**STUFF HEAD FIRMLY**
	R12	[2 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(18)**	-
	R13	sc in each st around	**(18)**	**NECK - narrowest point**
	R14	[2 sc, inc] x 6	**(24)**	body flares out

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R15	[3 sc, inc] x 6	**(30)**	-
	R16	[4 sc, inc] x 6	**(36)**	body at full width
	R17	sc in each st around	**(36)**	**arms at R17 - R18**
	R18	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R19	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R20	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R21	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R22	sc in each st around	**(36)**	-
	R23	[4 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(30)**	-
	R24	[3 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(24)**	**FEET attach at R24 - R25**
	R25	[2 sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(18)**	stuff body LIGHTLY
	R26	[sc, **invdec**] x 6	**(12)**	-
	R27	sc in each st around	**(12)**	**tail begins; mark dorsal fin anchor**

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R28	[2 sc, **invdec**] x 3	**(9)**	-
	R29	sc in each st around	**(9)**	-
	R30	sc in each st around	**(9)**	-
	R31	sc in each st around	**(9)**	-
	R32	[sc, **invdec**] x 3	**(6)**	light stuffing to here
	R33	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R34	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R35	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R36	sc in each st around	**(6)**	**taper to tip; tenth fin anchor**

Mark the fin path while you crochet
On each of Rnds 27-36, place a scrap-yarn marker through the surface stitch nearest the dorsal (top) centre of the tail. Keep the ten markers in one straight line rather than following the spiral's round start. These marked stitches are existing stitches, not extras; they give the fin ten unambiguous surface anchors.

Finish: fold the last 6 stitches flat so 3 pairs line up (3 front + 3 back), then work 1 sc through each pair - 3 sc in total - to close the tip cleanly. FO and weave the end away from the marked dorsal line so it cannot be mistaken for a fin anchor.

Instructions 2 - Arms & Feet (Main Pink)

Arms and feet are made separately and sewn on, not worked into the body, so each limb keeps its own rounded shape and can be set at the right angle.

Arms (make 2)

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R1	6 sc in MR	**(6)**	-
	R2	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R3	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R4	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R5	sc in each st around	**(6)**	-
	R6	sc in each st around, then FO	**(6)**	**arms finish here**

FO with a long tail, do not stuff. Flatten the open end and sew it closed as you attach, so the arms hang softly.

Feet (make 2)

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R1	6 sc in MR	**(6)**	-
	R2	[sc, inc] x 3	**(9)**	-
	R3	sc in each st around	**(9)**	-
	R4	sc in each st around	**(9)**	-
	R5	[sc, **invdec**] x 3	**(6)**	feet finish here

FO, cinch closed with a long tail and stuff lightly - do not flatten them, they are plump little balls. Sew each foot on with its closed nub facing the body.

Instructions 3 - Gills (Fuzzy Dark Pink, Make 6)

	Rnd	Instruction (US terms)	Sts	Note
	R1	6 sc in MR	**(6)**	-
	R2	inc in each st around	**(12)**	-
	R3	sc in each st around	**(12)**	-
	R4	sc in each st around	**(12)**	-
	R5	[sc, **invdec**] x 4	**(8)**	open edge sewn to head

> **Working with fuzzy yarn**
> You cannot see the stitches. Hold a thin strand of matching smooth yarn together with the fur yarn so you can find the stitches, or count by feel with the hook tip and trust the round count. Small errors are invisible in the finished fluff.

FO with a long tail. The 8-st open edge is sewn straight to the head and disappears in the fluff - simply whip-stitch it flat against the head. If you prefer a rounded lobe, cinch the front loops of the opening first with a spare strand, then whip-stitch the gathered edge to the head. Three fluffy gills fan behind each eye - upper angled up, middle out, lower down.

Instructions 4 - Tail Fin (Smooth Dark Pink)

With smooth dark pink yarn, join with a sl st at the tip end-closure corner. Working from the tip toward the body along the ten marked surface anchors from Rnds 36 back to 27:

- Work 5 dc in the next marked anchor, then sl st in the next marked anchor. Repeat from 4 more times - 5 scallops in total, using all 10 anchors. Remove each marker as you use it.
- FO after the fifth anchoring sl st and weave in.

Each scallop uses exactly 2 marked surface anchors, so five scallops use all 10 anchors. Do not hunt for an imaginary ridge or work into random side bars: the marked dorsal stitches are the path. Keep the final anchoring sl st close to the body junction; it lands on the R27 anchor. Work the dc groups loosely so each scallop cups outward. For a fuller paddle, first mark a second straight line of ten underside surface stitches (one per tail round), then work a second identical 5-scallop row there; do not stretch the dorsal row around the tip.

A note on fullness: five shells over ten rounds is meant to ruffle - the cupped, frilly edge is the look, not a mistake. If the scallops seem crowded, work the dc even more loosely, use half a hook size larger for the fin yarn only, or work 4 scallops on a shorter marked path.

Finishing & Assembly

Eyes and embroidery: complete them immediately after Rnd 9, before Rnd 10 narrows the head. The 6 mm eyes go between Rnds 7 and 8, 6 stitches apart and centred on the front; lock both washers from inside. While the 36-stitch opening is clear, embroider the smile and optional pink blush described below, knotting and burying all floss ends inside. Do this before stuffing at Rnd 11. Six stitches spans about 27 mm on the 52 mm head - about half the width. Once locked, check each eye and its surrounding stitches firmly by hand; this workshop check does not replace any prescribed product-safety test.

Smile: immediately after Rnd 9, use black floss to embroider a wide shallow U across Rnds 8-9, centred between the eyes and about 5 stitches wide. Keep it shallow; a deep curve reads as a frown. Knot and bury the floss ends inside.

Blush (optional): also immediately after Rnd 9, embroider two or three short pink stitches directly under each eye, just outside the eye line; knot and bury the floss ends inside. Do not use loose chalk or pastel on an item that may be handled or washed.

Gills: sew 3 lobes to each side of the head, behind the eyes, anchored at about R6 (upper), R7-R8 (middle) and R9 (lower). Angle the top lobe upward, the middle one straight out and the bottom one downward so they fan, then tease the fibres apart with a slicker brush or your fingers.

Arms: sew one arm to each side at R17-R18, about 6 stitches out from the centre front, angled slightly forward.

Feet: sew one foot to each side of the centre front at R24-R25, about 4 stitches out from centre, so Axel sits flat and upright.

Before you sew - lay every component out and check: 1 body, 2 arms, 2 feet, 6 gills, 1 fin. Check each against the pattern before attaching anything.

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1 body, 2 arms, 2 feet, 6 gills, 1 fin. Check each against the pattern before attaching anything.

Troubleshooting

Head firm, body soft	Stuff the head hard at R11 so it holds a sphere and the eyes stay level. Keep the body light so Axel stays squishy and sits down.
Neck collapsing	The 18-stitch neck is deliberately narrow. First pack a little more stuffing into the neck through the body opening before closing R25. For a permanently sturdier neck, work R13 as [7 sc, inc] x 2, 2 sc (20), then change R14 to [4 sc, inc] x 4 (24) so it consumes all 20 stitches; R15 onward is unchanged.
Want a wider gill span?	As written the gills give about 10 cm tip to tip. Work each gill two rounds longer - add 2 plain rounds at 12 stitches before R5 - for a span of about 12 cm.

Stuffing shows through	Go down to a 3.0 mm hook. Loose gauge on a 3.5 mm hook is the usual cause.
Axel will not sit	Move the feet one round lower, keep the body lightly stuffed, and shape the tail behind the body as a counterbalance.

Colourways & Care

Colourways:

Follow the labels for every yarn and component used, especially the fuzzy gill yarn. Before publishing a care claim or supplying finished Axels, clean and dry a complete sample by the proposed method, then remeasure it and inspect for dye transfer, fibre shedding or matting, stuffing migration, shifted eyes and opened seams. Until that sample test passes, recommend gentle surface cleaning with a damp cloth and drying flat away from heat. Check every eye, gill and limb again after cleaning.

Listing & care-card notes for sellers

Finished-item listings must credit Novality Store - Design Code NS-03. If a listing image is a render rather than a photograph of the actual item, disclose that in the description and keep the render labelled. Supply a care card with the yarn names and fibre content, the hook and gauge you used, the seated height and gill span, and the surface-clean-only advice until your own sample test passes. Make no toy-safety or age-suitability claim.

Project notes

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You may not

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Safety reminder

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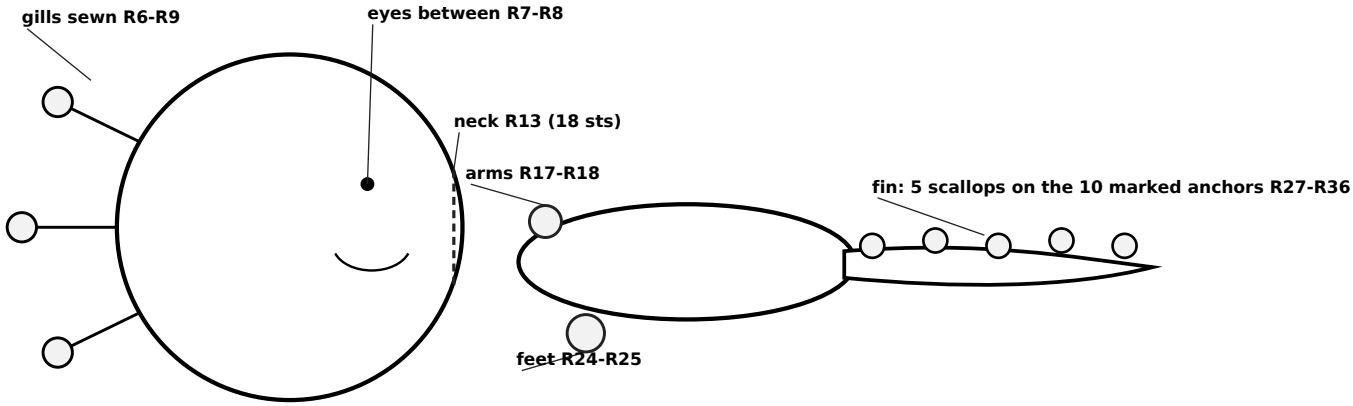
- [ ] **Body:** one piece, 36 rounds, tip closed with 3 sc
- [ ] **Arms:** 2 made, flattened ends sewn at R17-R18
- [ ] **Feet:** 2 made, cinched nubs sewn at R24-R25
- [ ] **Gills:** 6 made, 3 per side fanned at R6-R9

- [ ] **Fin:** 5 scallops on the 10 marked anchors
- [ ] **Eyes & face:** washers locked, smile and blush buried
- [ ] **Seams & ends:** every seam sewn twice, ends woven 5 cm

Finished-item record

Yarn brand, fibre & dye lot - main pink	
Yarn brand, fibre & dye lot - dark pink	
Hook used & gauge achieved (36 sc = mm across)	
Seated height, gill span and tail length (cm)	
Finish date & maker	

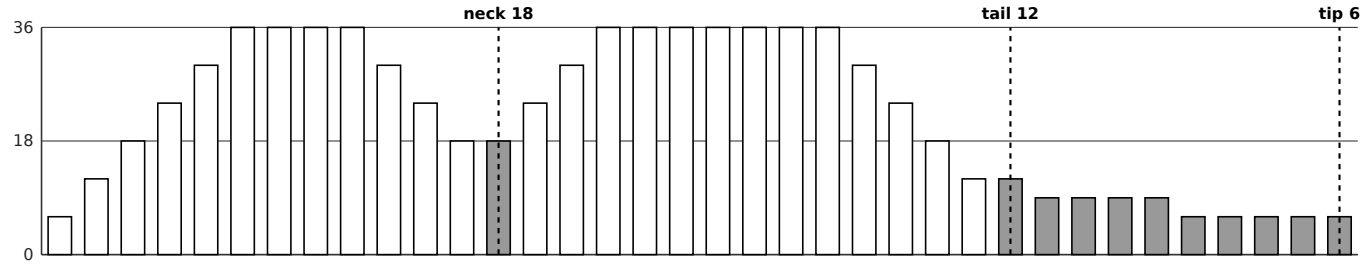
Appendix A - Visual Schematics, Assembly Map & Count Chart



Side schematic (not to scale): one spiral from crown to tail tip; sewn-on pieces marked at their stated rounds.

1 Body	2 Arms x 2	3 Feet x 2	4 Gills x 6	5 Fin	6 Finish
spiral R1-R36, close tip with 3 sc	6 sts x 6 rounds, sew at R17-R18	6-9-9-9-6, sew at R24-R25	6-12-12-12-8, sew at R6-R9	5 scallops on 10 marked anchors	eyes, smile, blush, block and check

Assembly order: body first, then limbs, gills and fin; face work happens at R9 while the head is still open.



Stated stitch count per round, R1-R36. Grey bars = neck and tail zones. Dashed lines = the three shaping transitions.

Appendix B - Machine-Verification & 5-Axiom Audit

Every round was re-derived from its written repeat: an increase round consumes the previous total and adds one stitch per repeat; a decrease round consumes two stitches per invisible decrease and returns one. Each round's consumed count must equal the previous stated total and its produced count must equal its own stated count, so no stitch is left unworked. All 36 body rounds and all 17 piece rounds pass.

Rnd	Cons.	Prod.	Stated	OK
1	0	6	6	**OK**
2	6	12	12	**OK**
3	12	18	18	**OK**
4	18	24	24	**OK**
5	24	30	30	**OK**
6	30	36	36	**OK**
7	36	36	36	**OK**
8	36	36	36	**OK**
9	36	36	36	**OK**
10	36	30	30	**OK**
11	30	24	24	**OK**
12	24	18	18	**OK**
13	18	18	18	**OK**
14	18	24	24	**OK**
15	24	30	30	**OK**
16	30	36	36	**OK**
17	36	36	36	**OK**
18	36	36	36	**OK**

Rnd	Cons.	Prod.	Stated	OK
19	36	36	36	**OK**
20	36	36	36	**OK**
21	36	36	36	**OK**
22	36	36	36	**OK**
23	36	30	30	**OK**
24	30	24	24	**OK**
25	24	18	18	**OK**
26	18	12	12	**OK**
27	12	12	12	**OK**
28	12	9	9	**OK**
29	9	9	9	**OK**
30	9	9	9	**OK**
31	9	9	9	**OK**
32	9	6	6	**OK**
33	6	6	6	**OK**
34	6	6	6	**OK**
35	6	6	6	**OK**
36	6	6	6	**OK**

Cons. = stitches consumed this round; Prod. = new stitches produced; Stated = the pattern's printed count; OK = consumed equals the previous stated total and produced equals this round's stated count. Piece ladders: arms 6 x 6 rounds; feet 6-9-9-9-6; gills 6-12-12-12-8 with an 8-st open edge; fin 5 scallops x 2 anchors = the 10 marked anchors of R27-R36; tip closure folds 6 sts into 3 pairs = 3 sc.

Verification summary

36 / 36 body rounds and 17 / 17 piece rounds pass the consumption and production rule with zero stitches left unworked; the fin anchor budget closes exactly (5 scallops x 2 anchors = 10); the tip closure folds 6 stitches into 3 pairs; both published variants (20-stitch neck, wider gill span) consume exactly their input counts; stated geometry follows from the gauge (36 x 4.5 mm / pi = 51.6 mm head diameter). Verification Method: Audited via deterministic static analysis (crochet-check v1.0.0 engine) and 5-Axiom mathematical proofs. All growth rounds and closures pass 100%.

5-Axiom audit summary (formal)

Axiom	What it guarantees	Evidence in this pattern	Result
1 · Domain Isolation	Rounds never count another piece's stitches	Arms, feet, gills and fin kept in separate tables	**PASS**
2 · Edge Lineage	Consumed counts trace to earlier stated totals	Every round consumes exactly the previous total	**PASS**
3 · Open Boundaries	No seam aimed at a closed ring or cinched point	Gill edge stays open at 8 sts; feet cinch after FO	**PASS**
4 · 2-Manifold Conservation	Every edge worked exactly once	36 / 36 body + 17 / 17 piece rounds pass; tip folds 6 to 3	**PASS**
5 · Gauge Bounding	Gauge inside the published worsted band	3.5 mm hook on worsted #4, tight amigurumi gauge stated	**PASS**

Audit executed by the deterministic crochet-check v1.0.0 static-analysis engine plus the count ladder above; no sampled or hand-checked results. Engine stages live: recorded fallback.

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